MISR LANGUAGE SCHOOLS
National Primary Stage

Grade 6

# Wonders

## Fiction



**Name:** _____

**Class:** _____

2026-2027
First Term

MISR LANGUAGE SCHOOLS National Primary Stage

English Language Arts

Primary VI

# Wonders

## Fiction Booklet

## School Year

## 2026/2027

Name: _____

Class: _____

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# Literary genres



each is read differently because they are written for different **purposes**, & are **organized** differently

## FICTION

**Purpose**

To entertain with a story

When we read **FICTION** we look for..

- ...main character
- ...goals
- ...problem
- solution
- outcome

## NON-FICTION

**Purpose**

To inform or explain real life

When we read **NON-FICTION** we look for..

- ...features
- ...main ideas
- ...important information
- ...organization

## POETRY

**Purpose**

To entertain with feelings & senses

When we read **POETRY** we look for..

- ...form
- ...speaker
- ...topic
- emotions
- message

## DRAMA

**Purpose**

comedy or tragedy

When we read **DRAMA** we look for..

- ...dialogue
- ...characters
- ...performance
- ...staging
- ...audience

**FICTION** sub genres

Fantasy · Mystery/Thriller · Science Fiction · Horror · Romance · Western

We put it all together to MAKE MEANING!!!

## Fiction

**Examples of Fiction Genres:**

1. **Realistic Fiction:**

   stories that could happen in real life, with believable characters and events

2. **Fantasy:**

   stories set in imaginary worlds with magical creatures, powers, or supernatural events

3. **Folktale:**

   traditional stories passed down orally, often teaching a lesson or explaining a custom

4. **Myth:**

   ancient stories that explain natural events, gods, or the origins of the world

5. **Science Fiction:**

   stories based on advanced science or technology, often set in the future or space

6. **Historical Fiction:**

   stories set in the past with fictional characters but real historical settings or events

7. **Fairy Tale:**

   magical stories for children that often include royalty, talking animals, and happy endings

8. **Tall Tale:**

   exaggerated, humorous stories about larger-than-life characters with unbelievable deeds

## Figures of Speech

**Figurative language is a powerful tool used in literature and everyday communication to add color, depth, and impact to our words. Instead of using words literally, figurative language employs figures of speech to create imagery, evoke emotions, express complex ideas simply, make language more creative and interesting, and make comparisons.**

### 1. Simile

A simile is a direct comparison between two unlike things using the words "like" or "as." It highlights a similarity between the two things being compared.

"Her smile was as bright as the sun."

### 2. Metaphor

A metaphor is a direct comparison between two unlike things without using "like" or "as." It states that one thing is another, implying a deeper connection or shared quality.

"The classroom was a zoo after the teacher left."

### 3. Personification

Personification is giving human qualities, characteristics, or actions to inanimate objects, animals, or abstract ideas.

"The wind whispered secrets through the trees."

### 4. Hyperbole

Hyperbole is an extreme exaggeration used for emphasis or effect, not meant to be taken literally. It creates a strong impression and can be humorous.

"I'm so hungry I could eat a horse."

### 5. Alliteration

Alliteration is the repetition of the same beginning consonant sound in words that are close together. It is often used for poetic effect or to create a particular rhythm.

"**P**eter **P**iper **p**icked a **p**eck of **p**ickled **p**eppers."

“The **sh**y **sh**eep **sh**uffled silently through the **sh**ady **sh**ed.”

“The **cl**ever **cl**own **cl**apped loudly and **cl**imbed the curtain.”

### 6. Onomatopoeia

Onomatopoeia is the formation of a word from a sound associated with what is named (e.g., cuckoo, sizzle). These words imitate the sounds they represent.

- "The bacon **sizzled** in the pan while the cat meowed loudly."
- “The clock **ticked** steadily on the wall.”

- “The fire **crackled** as the logs burned.”
- “The car **screeched** to a sudden stop.”

### 7. Idiom

An idiom is a phrase or expression whose meaning cannot be understood from the ordinary meaning of its individual words. Its meaning is culturally specific and often figurative.

"He's feeling under the weather." (meaning he's feeling sick)

### 8. Imagery

Imagery is the use of vivid and descriptive language that appeals to one or more of the five senses (sight, sound, smell, taste, touch) to create a mental picture for the reader. While not a single "figure of speech" in the same way as simile or metaphor, it's a broad category of figurative language.

"The crisp, cool air bit at her exposed skin, carrying the sweet scent of pine needles and the faint sound of rustling leaves."

### 9. Oxymoron

An oxymoron is a figure of speech in which apparently contradictory terms appear in conjunction. It combines two words with opposite meanings to create a surprising or thought-provoking effect.

- As the teacher entered the room, a **deafening silence** fell over the students.
  “Deafening silence” emphasizes how intense and heavy the quietness was.
- A **small crowd** gathered to watch the show.
  “Small crowd” emphasizes the presence of a few people, but still called a crowd.
- She let out a silent scream when the door creaked open.
  **“Silent scream”** shows intense emotions (expressing fear or shock) without sounds

**Ex**: pretty ugly, original copy, act naturally, clearly confused, bittersweet

**Understanding and utilizing these different types of figurative language can significantly enhance writing and communication, making it more engaging, memorable, and impactful.**

# Start Smart

# Unit 0 Week 1
# The Cricket and the Jaguar

## Essential Question:
## What discoveries can people make when they cooperate with others?

**The Cricket and the Jaguar**

**A folktale from Argentina**



In the heat of the bright noon sun, tiny Cricket was so happy he couldn't stop himself from chirping. Unfortunately, Bossy Jaguar was trying to take a nap nearby.

"Hey, you puny little pest," shouted Jaguar at the tiny insect, "stop chirping right now! It's annoying and I'm trying to sleep."

"I don't mean to annoy you," said Cricket, "but the sun is so warm; it makes me want to sing."

"Well, cut it out," growled the cranky cat. "Don't you see how much bigger I am than you?" To make his point, the jaguar opened his mouth as wide as possible, baring his shiny, sharp teeth.

"I'll see what I can do," answered Cricket.

Jaguar trotted away smugly, curled up, and drifted off to sleep. But the hot desert sun kept on shining, and Cricket felt so warm and content that he couldn't resist the temptation to sing out. He chirped a jolly chirp, and Jaguar woke up with a snarl.

"You have one more chance to be quiet. If you are not, I'll put an end to your annoying happy song once and for all!" Jaguar once again showed his fearsome teeth. But this time, he also raised the hair on his back, which made him look even bigger and more ferocious.

"I'll do my best," said Cricket.

Satisfied with his impressive display, Jaguar curled up once more and drifted off to sleep. But the desert sun kept shining, and Cricket felt too happy to stay quiet, so he chirped a loud, cheerful chirp.



"That's it!" roared Jaguar. "I declare war on all crickets!" Jaguar called together the pumas, boars, and armadillos and prepared to stamp out all annoying insects.

But Cricket called together the bees, wasps, and stinging ants and told them about Jaguar's threats. They all agreed to help fight back.

The battle was short and sweet for the insects. Painfully stung, all of Jaguar's allies ran away. Jaguar stood alone on the battlefield, crying from the sharp stings.

"You see," whispered Cricket into one of Jaguar's swollen, bee-stung ears, "there is no such thing as a small enemy."

Jaguar slunk off to wait for his swelling to go down. Cricket returned to saluting the bright sun with his joyful, triumphant chirping.

**Directions: Answer the following questions after reading the folktale.**

1. **How did the setting "In the bright noon sun" cause the conflict between Cricket and Jaguar?**

_____

_____

2. **What details indicate that Jaguar thinks his size is enough to make Cricket stop singing? Cite text evidence.**

_____

_____

_____

3. **Read the following excerpt.**
   "But the hot desert sun kept on shining, and Cricket felt so warm and **content** that he couldn't resist the temptation to sing out. He chirped a jolly chirp, and Jaguar woke up with a snarl."
   **What is a synonym for "content"?**
   a. sad b. nervous c. happy d. angry

4. **A. What kind of character is Jaguar based on lines 5-16?**

_____

_____

   **B. What does Cricket's reaction tell us about him?**

_____

_____

5. **A. What was the reason Jaguar reached his climatic point and declared "war on all crickets"?**

_____

_____

**B. How could the climax have been avoided?**

_____

_____

6. **What does it mean when the passage says the battle was "short and sweet for the insects"? How is that an example of figurative language?**

_____

_____

_____

7. **What do Jaguar's actions after the battle tell you about how his view of himself has changed? (Refer to lines 30 to 37)**

_____

_____

_____

8. **Read the following excerpt.**

"Painfully stung, all of Jaguar's **allies** ran away. Jaguar stood alone on the battlefield, crying from the sharp stings."

**What is an <u>antonym</u> for "allies"?**

a. supporters b. friends c. helpers d. enemies

9. **Read the following excerpt.**

"Jaguar <u>slunk off</u> to wait for his swelling to go down."

**A. What do the phrase "<u>slunk off</u>" and the word "swelling" tell us about how Jaguar was feeling and acting?**

_____

_____

**B. How does this phrase show that Jaguar isn't as powerful as he pretends to be?**

_____

_____

10. **How might the story have been different if Jaguar had responded kindly to Cricket from the beginning?**

_____

_____

_____

11. **Infer the main theme and cite text evidence in support.**

_____

_____

_____

_____

12. **Which character does the narrator favour? Cite text evidence.**

_____

_____

_____

_____

13. **A. Circle <u>two</u> features that show that "The Cricket and the Jaguar" is a folktale.**
    a. It teaches a lesson.
    b. It is passed down from generation to generation.
    c. It is the true story of a person's life written by someone other than the subject.
    d. It is set in an actual place and time in the past.

    **B. Why do most folktales end with the smaller/weaker character winning?**
    a. Because the smaller character is usually the strongest.
    b. Because folktales often teach that intelligence, kindness, or courage can overcome strength.
    c. Because the larger character always makes friends with everyone.
    d. Because the weaker character has magical powers in every story.

**14. Fill in the chart using your own words.**

| Plot Element | What Happens in the Story |
|---|---|
| **Exposition** | Setting + Characters Introduced |
| **Rising Action** | The conflict builds up. |
| **Climax** | The Peak of the Problem |
| **Falling Action** | The Plan to Fight |
| **Resolution** | The Lesson Learnt |

# Selection 1

## Unit 1 Week 1
## Cow Music

## Weekly Concept:
**Perspectives**

## Essential Question:
**How do new experiences offer new perspectives?**

# Crossing the Creek

Ever since Maricia could remember, she had been a shy girl. She would have been perfectly happy to spend the summer in her room reading mystery novels, but her dad insisted that she go to camp. Before she knew it, she had boarded a bus full of excited campers and was on her way to Lake Fraser. "How am I going to spend an entire week with kids I don't know?" she asked herself.

On the first day, Maricia and her bunkmates went on an early morning hike. Cara, their counselor, led them in a single-file line along a narrow, leafy trail. Maricia noticed that Amanda, the girl who was last in line, seemed even shyer than she did. In fact, Amanda hadn't uttered a word all day. 1

After about an hour, the hikers arrived at a wide creek. The only way to cross it was to walk across a wooden plank. Filled with doubt, Maricia paused at the edge of the rushing water. 2

But then she imagined walking across the balance beam in gymnastics class, and she realized that this might be similar. Holding out her arms to steady herself, she took a few steps, trying not to notice the icy water and slippery rocks below. Slowly and carefully, she made her way across. 3

"That wasn't so bad!" Maricia told herself. Then she realized that Amanda was still on the other side, looking frightened.

Usually, Maricia wouldn't feel comfortable giving other people advice, but not this time. The words flew out of her mouth before she could stop them. "I was scared too, but I just thought about being on the balance beam in gymnastics. It's basically the same thing. Try it!" Maricia encouraged.

Cautiously, Amanda put one foot on the plank and then hesitated. "Just a few more steps!" Maricia cheered, as Cara stood by to help. Amanda kept going, and seconds later she was by Maricia's side.

"That wasn't so bad, either," Maricia thought. It was funny how helping someone made her feel less shy. As she and Amanda raced to catch up with the others, Maricia realized she was looking forward to what the rest of the week had in store.

**Listening Comprehension:**

**Crossing the Creek**



**Listen to the story, then answer the following questions.**

1. **What is the genre of the text? Support your answer.**

_____

_____

2. **How can visualization help you understand what "single-file" means?**

_____

_____

3. **What descriptive details can help you visualize the setting?**

_____

_____

4. **How can visualizing help understand Maricia's feelings?**

_____

_____

5. **In what way did Maricia feel differently at the end compared to the beginning?**

_____

_____

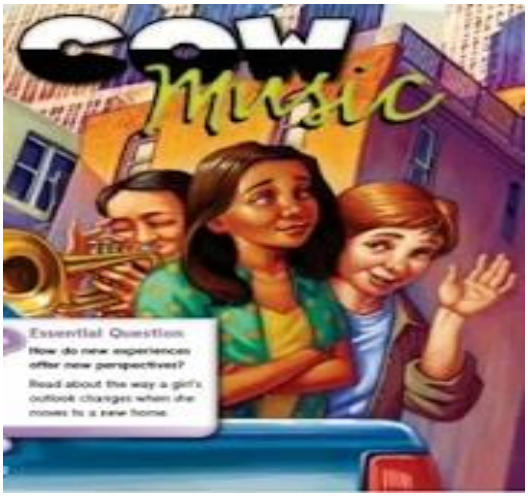
6. **Maricia changed her _____ about the camp after spending a week there.**

a. perspective b. attitude c. manners d. story

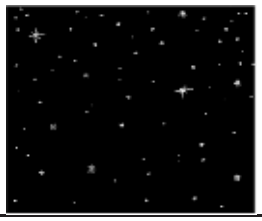
## Wonders Vocabulary

**Reading Selection:** **Cow Music**

| Word | Definition |
|---|---|
| **threshold (n.)** | an entrance or boundary |
| **consolation (n.)** | something that provides comfort or relief during a time of loss |
| **glimmer (n.)** | a faint idea or sign |
| **heinous (adj.)** | shockingly bad |
| **indispensable (adj.)** | necessary or essential |
| **perception (n.)** | the way you think about a situation or issue |
| **phobic (adj.)** | having a fear of something |
| **sarcastic (adj.)** | a person who uses sharp or ironic words to insult or hurt someone |



**A. Use the word chart to study this week's vocabulary words.**

| Word | Context Sentence | Illustration |
|---|---|---|
| **consolation** | The card gave the girl some consolation after she moved. |  |
| **glimmer** | The stars glimmer in the night sky. |  |
| **sarcastic** | His sarcastic words hurt his brother's feelings. |  |
| **threshold** | I crossed the threshold and entered the classroom. |  |
| **phobic** | The girl is phobicof chickens. |  |
| **heinous** | Washing dishes can be a heinous job. |  |

**B. <u>Directions:  Fill in the blanks using the words below</u>.**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| consolation | glimmer | indispensable | perception |
| phobic | sarcastic | threshold | heinous |

1. His decision to quit without notice was _____**,** leaving the team in a difficult position.
2. She offered _____ to her friend after the tough news, knowing a kind word could make a difference.
3. A tiny _____ of hope appeared on the horizon, suggesting things might still turn around.
4. In a crisis, a clear _____ of the situation is crucial for effective decision-making.
5. He was often _____**,** his dry wit sometimes misinterpreted by those who didn't know him well.
6. The old dog, though frail, was an _____ part of their family.
7. She stood on the _____ of a new adventure, eager to see what lay ahead.
8. He was _____ about heights, even the sight of a tall building made him uneasy.

**C. <u>Directions: Fill in the blanks using the words below</u>.**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| sarcastic | glimmer | indispensable | phobic |
| perception | threshold | consolation | heinous |

1. There was a _____ of happiness in her eyes that made me feel safe.
2. He had a kind of _____ expression on his face that hurt Maggie's feelings.
3. Mike is _____ about spiders.
4. Flowers were bought for the teacher as a _____ for the children's misbehaviour.
5. The young man committed a _____ crime.
6. Mr. Green is the most _____ member of the team.
7. Jim crossed the _____ of his new villa.
8. Her _____ about Tina has changed after getting to know her well.

**A. <u>Directions: Read the passage, then answer the questions that follow.</u>**

## SMART START

Normally, the cafeteria was so noisy you couldn't hear a tray drop. But now, Alex's footsteps echoed across the huge room. There were a few other scattered students in the cafeteria, all avoiding eye contact with one another. The Dunce Convention, Alex thought, as his backpack landed with a loud **thud** on the table. He was here after school for his first sessionin "Smart Start," a program in which students received free tutoring in subjects that were difficult for them. Alex wondered whom the school thought they were fooling with their opposite-name trick. Smart Start meant "Stupid Forever."

Alex had been sentenced to Smart Start for math. His parents, already concerned about his grades, were even more agitated because the Statewide Math Aptitude Test was approaching. (Also oppositely named, Alex thought; in his case, it should be the Inaptitude Test.) Math had always been torture for Alex. For extra humiliation, his little sister had accelerated and was taking the same math subject as he, despite being almost two years younger.

Alex unearthed the crumpled registration form and quickly began to fidget with it, a nervous habit of his. Absentmindedly, he folded over the strip with his name on it repeatedly, scoring it until there was a sharp crease. Next, he tore the strip off, bracing the page against the edge of the table. What remained was a nearly perfect square—ideal for one of Alex's favorite pastimes: origami.

He began folding one of the common origami patterns, the bird base. Using his thumbnail to form the sharp creases, Alex created a triangle and added some petal folds. Soon, the bird base was complete, and he was partway into making the crane. So absorbed was he that he didn't hear the footsteps of the person approaching his table.

"You must be Alex. I'm Sophia," announced the girl, extending her hand. Startled, Alex quickly shoved his folded paper aside. Sophia continued, "I'm in eighth grade. Tell me a little bit about yourself. What do you like to do?"
Anything but math!" Alex replied.

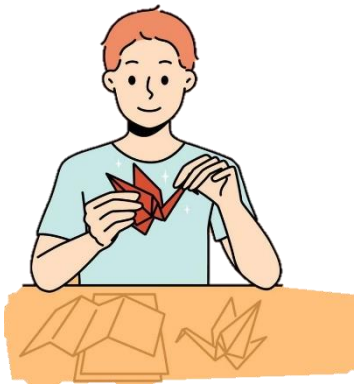
"Well, I guess that's why you're here," Sophia said with a laugh. "I used to hate math, too," She offered.

Alex recognized that Sophia was making an effort to put him at ease, so he granted her a quick smile. "What made you start to like it?" he asked politely.

"Believe it or not, I think it was the marching band. I realized that counting beats

and tracking measures is all about math. Hey, what's that you're hiding?" she teased, tugging at his folded form.

"It's nothing yet, but soon it will be," Alex explained. Quickly, Alex folded and creased, his hands awhirl. "Ta-da—a crane!" he proclaimed, presenting the transformed shape. "That's awesome," Sophia declared, staring intently at the origami folds. "Do you mind if I take it apart?" Alex shrugged, and Sophia carefully unfolded each step of the crane, leaving a geometric wonder of creases. Sophia looked excited about the wrinkled sheet, and Alex raised his eyebrows.



"Don't you see? What you have here is most of your math curriculum, right in front of you!" She flattened the paper out with the palm of her hand. "Do your first fold," she commanded, and Alex complied. "You began with a square and created two rectangles. And you have a fraction, too: one-half! Fold it again… and, magic, now you have four quarters." Sophia pointed to the top fold. "What fraction does this flap represent?"

"One quarter?" Alex responded.

"Duh! Obviously, right? Get out some more paper, and let's do some geometry!"

If math tutoring were going to be origami, Alex thought, maybe it would be a Smart Start after all.

**B. <u>Directions: Answer the following questions.</u>**

1. **A. Picture the cafeteria in mind. Mention three details from lines 1-4 that help you visualize how noisy and big it was?**

_____

_____

**B. "**Normally, the cafeteria was so noisy you couldn't hear a tray drop. But now, Alex's footsteps echoed across the huge room. "

**What's the author trying to show using this contrast?**

_____

_____

2. **Read this sentence from the passage.**

   "The Dunce Convention, Alex thought, as his backpack landed with a loud **thud** on the table."

   **What does "thud" mean in the sentence above?**

   a. bang  b. bug  c. scream  d. cry

3. **"Alex had been <u>sentenced</u> to Smart Start for math." How does the word choice of "sentenced" help you understand how Alex feels?**

   _____

   _____

   _____

4. **Why does Alex refer to Smart Start as an "opposite-name trick"?**

   _____

   _____

   _____

5. **What does Alex do just before he meets Sophia for the first time?**

   _____

   _____

   _____

6. **What character trait does Sophia show in:**
   **lines 25-27 _____**
   **line 29 _____**
   **lines 41 & 42 _____**

7. **What caused Alex to change his attitude about Smart Start by the end of the story?**

   _____

   _____

   _____

8. **Infer the main theme and cite text evidence in support.**

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

**9. What similarities and differences do you see between Alex's attitude at the beginning of the story and the end?**

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

**10. Circle <u>two</u> features that show that "Smart Start" is realistic fiction.**

a. It focuses on a real person's important achievements in life.

b. It has dialogue that shows what the characters say.

c. It includes imaginary characters like talking animals.

d. It is centered around events and problems that real people experience.

**A. Directions: Read each passage. Underline the context clues that help you figure out the meaning of the word in bold. Then write the word's meaning on the line.**

1. Math had always been torture for Alex. For extra humiliation, hislittle sister had **accelerated** and was taking the same math subject as he, despite being almost two years younger.

_____

2. Soon the bird base was complete, and he was partway into making the crane. So **absorbed** was he, that he didn't hear thefootsteps of the person approaching his table.

_____

3. Alex recognized that Sophia was making an effort to put him at ease, so he **granted** her a quick smile. "What made you startto like it?" he asked politely.

_____

**B. Directions: Use what you know about context clues to explain the followingword in a sentence: pastime. Be sure to include context clues that explain the word's meaning.**

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

**A. <u>Directions: Read the passage. Use the "visualize" strategy to help you form mental images as you read.</u>**

## The Fearsome Machine

"I will never ride in one of those fearsome machines!" Abraham declared crossly. Abraham was clearly **irked**, his bushy gray eyebrows lowering in an annoyed scowl as he looked up at his nephew. The two men were walking in an open field behind Abraham's farmhouse, enjoying the sunshine. The year was 1915, and the first automobile had just arrived in the town of Westbrook.



"It's called an automobile, Uncle Abraham," replied his nephew impatiently. "This is a new century. We've got to move with the times." Bob was a young man who seemed in perpetual motion, always walking or jogging from place to place and quite unable to sit still. This energy served him well. As the only doctor in Westbrook, he was frequently called out at all hours of the day and night. "Every time I go out on calls with the horse, I have to harness her and hitch her up to the buggy," Bob continued. "With the automobile, I will just crank it, start it up, and go!"

"Maybe you save a little time," Abraham allowed. "But what about the disadvantages? A horse is quiet. You don't wake up the whole town when you go out at night in your buggy. Those automobiles make a terrible racket! And a horse eats good hay and oats from the farm. You're going to have to buy gasoline to feed that new machine."

"But a horse has to eat every day, and I will only fill up the car when it runs out of gasoline," Bob replied. "Admit it, Uncle Abraham, you don't trust any novelty because you don't like things that haven't been around for a while."

A few days later, Abraham heard the unfamiliar clatter of a - machine outside the farmhouse. He ran out front in time to see Bob driving an automobile on the way to visit a patient. The young doctor was obviously elated with the new vehicle, a delighted grin lighting his face as he bounced excitedly in his seat.

Abraham, in contrast, was frowning as he grumbled. "Well, I was right about the noise!"

As the days went on, however, he found himself thinking about the Model T. It had been so strange, after all, to see something that looked so much like a carriage advancing without a horse to pull it! At last, he headed into Westbrook to visit Bob and the automobile.

When Abraham arrived, he found Bob and the automobile in the shed behind the house. The Model T's engine cover was open. Bob was frowning at the engine in puzzlement.

"Uncle Abraham, I'm glad you're here!" the young man called out. "You've got that wonderful talent for fixing things, and this engine doesn't seem to be working properly."

"And there's another difference between horses and engines— horses don't break down!" Abraham exclaimed triumphantly.

"Yes, but horses do get sick sometimes," said Bob. "And engines can be repaired, just as horses can recover from illnesses."

Abraham was forced to agree with this point, but before he could speak, his attention was drawn to the gleaming engine in front of him. "So how does this wondrous machine of yours work, anyway?" he asked. "Oh wait, I see..." His sentences broke into quiet mumbles as he became absorbed in studying the parts before him. Bob just smiled as he watched his uncle work on the engine.

After about an hour of tinkering, Abraham looked up. "I think I've got it now," he said happily. "Try cranking it." With a few pops and bangs, the engine sputtered to life. "Come on! Let's take this thing out for a ride!" Abraham exclaimed eagerly.

"But Uncle Abraham, I thought you'd never want to ride in my fearsome machine," teased Bob.

Abraham blushed and grumbled a bit. "Well, that was before I saw the engine," he admitted. "It's just so much fun to work on!"

And so, Abraham began to welcome progress with the zeal of an excited child opening birthday presents. "After all, this is a new century," he would tell anyone. "We've got to move with the times!"

**B. <u>Directions: Answer the following questions</u>**.

**1.** A. When and where does the story take place?

_____

B. Why is the setting important to the story?

a. It explains why Abraham is excited about horses.
b. It helps readers understand why the automobile seems new and unusual.
c. It tells readers where Bob works.
d. It explains why the engine stopped working.

**2.** Read this sentence from the passage.

"Abraham was clearly irked, his bushy gray eyebrows lowering in an annoyed scowl as he looked up at his nephew."

What does "irked" mean in the sentence above?

a. angry b. frightened c. amused d. tired

**3.** Why do you think Abraham was so strongly against the automobile at the beginning of the story?

_____

_____

_____

**4.** Read this sentence from the passage.

"And there's another difference between horses and engines— horses don't break down!" Abraham exclaimed triumphantly."

**What does the word "triumphantly" most likely mean as used in the sentence?**

a. with sadness b. with pride and joy c. with confusion d. with fear

**5.** Read the following figurative language on line 20. "You don't wake up the whole town when you go out at night in your buggy."

A. Identify the figurative language used.

_____

B. Explain it.

_____

_____

**6.** Why did the author compare the engine to a sick horse in the conversations?

a. To entertain the readers.

b. To show how engines work.

c. To show the different opinions about new technology.

d. To explain how engines can be fixed.

**7.** Using details to support your answer, what can you infer about Bob's personality from the following lines?

- 7-16 _____
- 23-25 _____
- 39-49 _____

**8.** What does Abraham mean when he says, "We've got to move with the times!"?

a. People should always keep using old ways.

b. People should stop using automobiles

c. People should use only horses for transportation.

d. People should accept and adapt to new ideas and inventions.

**9.** A. How does the narrator use both Abraham's and Bob's points of view to show the story's main message?

_____

_____

_____

B. Which statement best expresses the main message of the story?

a. Horses are always better than automobiles.

b. Doctors should own automobiles to do their jobs.

c. People can change their opinions when they are willing to learn about new ideas.

d. New inventions are bad.

**10.** Based on the ending of the story, what do you think Abraham might say or do the next time a new invention comes to Westbrook?

_____

_____

_____

_____

**11.** Choose <u>two</u> features that show that "The Fearsome Machine" is historical fiction.

a. It has made-up characters.

b. It has talking animals.

c. It is fictional, but the historical details are accurate and believable.

d. It talks about the achievements of a real person.

**A. <u>Directions: Read the passage, then answer the questions that follow.</u>**

## More than "Man's Best Friend"

"Not again!" Julia cried to her parents. They had just told her the family would be moving overseas to a foreign land, far from home. Julia knew that meant she would have to leave her dog behind.

Julia loved dogs because they were so devoted, always there when a person needed a friend. These were important qualities to Julia because her family's life never felt very stable. Since her father was in the army, they moved to a new army base every few years. She could take along her books and toys, but bringing her dog was out of the question.

As an adult, Julia settled in a bustling city. Her apartment was small, and she had no backyard. But she could not forget her fantasy about adopting a dog, so one day she finally gave in to her heart's desire. She brought home a beautiful black and tan German shepherd puppy named Lucy.



Julia spent so much time playing outside with Lucy that she soon decided to move to the country. The city was noisy and dirty, but the country was beautiful. Julia and Lucy loved the peacefulness of their new home, and Julia felt her dreams had come true.

One day, Julia saw a news story about a group of hikers who went missing in the mountains. The ski patrol searched for the hikers, and so did volunteers with search-and-rescue dogs.

From this story, Julia learned how search-and-rescue dogs are different from other dogs. The best search-and-rescue dogs are so filled with motivation that they are willing to work hard for a reward, like a toy or praise. To search-and-rescue dogs, looking for lost people was like playing a game. Julia thought of a game that Lucy enjoyed playing in which Julia hid a favorite toy and Lucy searched until she found it. Could Lucy be a natural search-and-rescue dog?

Soon, Julia began training with a group of dog handlers and their search-and-rescue dogs. Lucy's first task was to find a toy, and when she did, to let Julia know by barking. Later in the training, Lucy looked for a person who was hiding. Finally, Lucy looked for a person who was lying on the ground, pretending to be injured. With each successful find, Lucy received a chewy toy along with a hearty "Good dog!" Julia trained too, running, biking, and climbing, so she would be strong enough to keep up with Lucy.

Julia would never forget their first search-and-rescue mission. She received a phone call in the middle of the night. Three college students had gone hiking in the woods and had not come home. The woods were filled with caves, ravines, and other dangers. Julia and Lucy immediately hopped into the car.

At the site, Julia met up with her team and got her assignment. As the sun rose in the sky, she took Lucy down a path. Filled with anxiety and concern for the safety of the missing students, Julia called out their names. Lucy ran ahead, nose in the air, sniffing for the scent of humans. They spent hours along the trail, but when they came back to the meeting point, they learned that another team had found the hikers. “Good dog, Lucy,” Julia said. She was proud they had helped, even though she felt a little bit disappointed that she and Lucy had not found the students.

Julia and Lucy’s next opportunity to help came soon enough. One day, an earthquake shook the city in which Julia had once lived. Again, Julia and Lucy drove off and quickly met up with their team of search-and-rescue volunteers.

What Julia saw astonished her. Fire and smoke threatened to cover the city. Many people were missing or injured. Once emergency workers determined the city was safe, special rescue groups were allowed to begin their work. Lucy and Julia joined other trained volunteers to search the city blocks for people waiting for rescuers. Using her nose as a guide, Lucy led emergency workers to people stuck in the rubble. Julia felt honored to be involved in this serious business of saving lives. She enjoyed doing the job and, most importantly, helping those in need. She also knew that she and Lucy had found their calling in life, and that they would always be a part of a rescue team.

**B. <u>Directions: Answer the following questions.</u>**

1. Why wasn't Julia able to keep her dogs with her in her early years?

_____

_____

_____

2. What can we infer about Julia's personality based on her decision to adopt a dog, even though her apartment was small and in the city?

_____

_____

_____

3. Why did Julia believe Lucy might be a natural search-and-rescue dog?

_____

_____

_____

4. Why do you think Julia felt disappointed when another team found the lost hikers, even though she and Lucy had done their best? (Refer to lines 38 to 44)

_____

_____

_____

5. Read the sentence from the passage.
   "Filled with **anxiety** and concern for the safety of the missing students, Julia called out their names."
   **What does anxiety mean in the sentence above?**
   a. anger b. confusion c. wonder d. worry

6. Read the sentence from the passage.

**“**What Julia saw **astonished** her. Fire and smoke threatened to cover the city.”
**What is an antonym for the word "astonished" in the sentence.**

a. surprised b. amazed c. shocked d. unimpressed

7. What does Julia’s reaction to the earthquake rescue mission reveal about her character and sense of purpose? (Refer to the last paragraph)

_____

_____

8. Why do you think Julia says that she and Lucy “found their calling in life”?

_____

_____

_____

9. A. How does the relationship between Julia and Lucy evolve throughout the story?

_____

_____

B. What does this say about the emotional connection between humans and animals?

_____

_____

10. Based on how Julia and Lucy handled their past missions, what do you think they might do in the future?

_____

_____

_____

_____

# Vocabulary for Writing

**Prompt 1:** Practicing sports is good for practicing your skills, or does it take up your free time? State both views.

| Word / Expression | Definition |
|---|---|
| boost | to increase or improve something, making it stronger, better, or more effective |
| reduce | to make something smaller, less, or lower in amount, degree, or size. |
| expense | the amount of money needed to buy or do something |
| play a vital role | to have an important or essential part in a situation, process, or event. |
| opponents | people who disagree with, compete against, or fight against something or someone. |
| proponents | supporters, advocates |
| time-consuming | taking a lot of time to complete or do |
| physical exhaustion | extreme tiredness of the body, usually after a lot of physical activity, work, or exercise. |
| give it your all **(idiom)** | to try as hard as you can; to put in maximum effort. |
| push oneself too hard **(idiom)** | to make yourself do more than your body or mind can comfortably handle, often leading to stress, exhaustion, or injury |

**A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the correct word or adjectival phrase from the box.**

| boost – reduce – time-consuming – expense – opponents – physical exhaustion |
|---|

1. Preparing for the school play was _____, so she had little time for homework.
2. After running for three hours without a break, he collapsed from _____.
3. Planting more trees can _____ air pollution in the city.
4. Paying for the party decorations was a big _____ for him this month.
5. A healthy diet can _____ your immune system.
6. Some _____ argued that the new law would hurt small businesses.

**B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the correct expression or idiom from the box**.

| plays a vital role – push oneself too hard – give it her all- proponents |
|---|

1. She decided to _____ during the final match.
2. Tammy _____ during training and ended up injuring her ankle.
3. Many _____ of recycling argue that it protects the environment.
4. Teamwork _____ in completing large projects successfully.

**C. Directions: Choose the correct answer.**

1. Good communication skills **_____** in building strong relationships.

   a. reduce  b. proponents  c. opponents  d. play a vital role

2. Drinking enough water can **_____** your energy and focus.

   a. boost  b. give it your all  c. expense  d. opponents

3. The critics were **_____** of the new strategy.

   a. opponents b. reduce  c. expense  d. increase productivity

4. Using public transport can _____ traffic congestion in cities.

   a. expense  b. proponents  c. reduce  d. boost

5. The _____ of school uniforms believe that they help students focus on learning.

   a. reduce  b. opponents  c. expense  d. proponents

6. He _____ during practice and ended up feeling exhausted.

   a. expense  b. pushed himself too hard  c. reduce  d. boost

7. Adam decided to _____ during the exam preparation.

   a. proponents  b. give it his all  c. boost  d. reduce

8. The soldiers endured days of _____ during their intense training exercises.

   a. expense  b. opponents  c. boost  d. physical exhaustion

9. Writing a detailed research paper can be very _____.

   a. boost  b. reduce  c. proponents  d. time-consuming

10. Buying a new laptop was a major _____ for her this month.

    a. expense  b. give it his all  c. boost  d. physical exhaustion

**D. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.**

1. Eating lots of junk food can **boost** your health. (  )
2. Buying a car can be a huge **expense** for most families. (  )
3. Planting trees can **reduce** air pollution. (  )
4. After running the marathon, he felt no **physical exhaustion**. (  )
5. The sun **plays a vital role** in giving us heat and light. (  )
6. Preparing for the school festival was very **time-consuming**. (  )
7. **Proponents** remain neutral and do not support either side of an argument. (  )

8. You can **give it your all** by sleeping all day and doing nothing. ( )
9. Some people are **opponents** of unfair rules. ( )
10. She **pushed herself too hard** during practice and injured her shoulder. ( )

**Prompt 2:** Some believe that celebrating birthdays is beneficial, while others believe the opposite. State both views.

| Word / Expression | Definition |
|---|---|
| pressure to impress | feeling stressed or anxious because you want others to like you or think highly of you. |
| create memories | to do things that will be remembered in the future; to make experiences worth recalling. |
| strengthen bonds | to improve and make relationships closer or stronger. |
| show appreciation | to express thanks or recognition for someone's actions or efforts. |
| exclusion | feeling left out or envious when others are included in something you are not |
| feel valued | to feel recognized, respected, and important to others. |
| cost an arm and a leg **(idiom)** | to be very expensive. |
| count your blessings **(idiom)** | to focus on and be thankful for the good things in your life. |
| owe someone a debt of gratitude **(idiom)** | to feel very thankful to someone because of their help or kindness. |
| a pain in the neck **(idiom)** | something or someone that is very annoying or troublesome. |

**A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| **exclusion – create memories – strengthen bonds – show appreciation – felt valued** |
|---|

1. A heartfelt thank-you note is a good way to _____.
2. Traveling with friends helps _____ that last a lifetime.
3. Family dinners can _____ between relatives.
4. She _____ when her boss recognized her hard work.
5. He felt sad because of his _____ from the school trip.

**B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| **pressure to impress – cost an arm and a leg – count your blessings – owe someone a debt of gratitude – a pain in the neck** |
|---|

1. I _____ my teacher _____ for helping me succeed.
2. She felt _____ her teachers with a perfect science project.
3. Sometimes, dealing with a slow computer is really _____.
4. Even during difficult times, it's important to _____.
5. That luxury car _____, but he bought it anyway.

**C. Directions: Choose the correct answer.**

1. The student experienced **_____** when he was not invited to join the group project.

   a. feel valued
   b. exclusion
   c. count your blessings
   d. show appreciation

2. Birthday parties are a fun way to **_____** with friends.

   a. owe them a debt of gratitude
   b. cost an arm and a leg
   b. create memories
   d. a pain in the neck

3. Complimenting someone can make them **_____**.

   a. exclusion
   b. cost an arm and a leg
   c. a pain in the neck
   d. feel valued

4. Spending quality time together can **_____** in a family.

   a. strengthen bonds
   b. count your blessings
   c. cost an arm and a leg
   d. feel valued

5. A messy room can sometimes be _____ to clean.

a. count your blessings
b. pressure to impress
c. a pain in the neck
d. show appreciation

**6.** He felt _____ his teammates during the championship match

a. count your blessings
b. cost an arm and a leg
c. a pain in the neck
d. pressure to impress

7. That handbag _____, but she saved for months to buy it.

a. strengthen bonds
b. exclusion
c. cost an arm and a leg
d. show appreciation

8. Writing thank-you letters is a way to _____.

a. a pain in the neck
b. show appreciation
c. cost an arm and a leg
d. pressure to impress

9. After receiving help, I truly _____.

a. strengthen bonds
b. a pain in the neck
c. owe them a debt of gratitude
d. exclusion

10. Even small daily wins remind us to _____.

a. exclusion
b. a pain in the neck
c. count our blessings
d. cost an arm and a leg

**D. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.**

1. His **exclusion** from the team made him feel disappointed and lonely. ( )
2. She felt **pressure to impress** her guests by planning a perfect birthday party. ( )
3. Ignoring your friends always **strengthens bonds**. ( )
4. Family vacations can't help but **create memories** that last a lifetime. ( )
5. Writing a thank-you note is a way to **show appreciation**. ( )
6. Spending time with someone can make them **feel valued**. ( )
7. That luxury car **cost an arm and a leg**, but it was free. ( )
8. A broken chair is **a pain in the neck** to sit on. ( )
9. Helping someone in need can make you **owe them a debt of gratitude**. ( )
10. Complaining about everything is a good way to **count your blessings**. ( )

**Prompt 3:** Write about the pros and cons of playing video games.

| Word / Expression | Definition |
|---|---|
| addiction | a strong dependence on a substance, activity, or habit that is hard to stop. |
| aggression | hostile or violent behavior or feelings toward others. |
| social isolation | the state of being separated from social interactions or relationships with others. |
| moderation | doing something in a balanced way, not too much or too little. |
| problem-solving skills | the ability to find solutions to difficult or complex situations. |
| develop quick thinking | to improve the ability to make fast decisions or react rapidly. |
| enhance hand-eye coordination | to improve the ability to use your hands and eyes together effectively. |
| encourage creativity | to inspire or promote imaginative and original thinking. |
| a great way to unwind **(idiom)** | an effective method to relax and relieve stress. |
| get carried away **(idiom)** | to become overly involved, excited, or enthusiastic about something. |

**A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| **problem-solving skills – moderation – enhance hand-eye coordination – a great way to unwind – got carried away** |
|---|

1. Playing chess can help enhance your _____.
2. He _____ talking and forgot the time.
3. Playing sports can _____.
4. Spending time in nature is _____ after a stressful day.
5. Eating sweets in _____ is better for your health.

**B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| **addiction – aggression – social isolation – develop quick thinking – encourage creativity** |
|---|

1. Video games can _____ when used wisely.
2. Getting angry easily is a sign of _____.
3. Art activities can _____.
4. Watching TV all day without breaks may lead to _____.
5. People who cannot stop using their phones may suffer from _____.

**C. Directions: Choose the correct answer.**

1. Painting and drawing can _____ in children.

   a. aggression
   b. social isolation
   c. encourage creativity
   d. addiction

2. Playing basketball regularly can _____.

   a. enhance hand-eye coordination
   b. aggression
   c. get carried away
   d. problem-solving skills

3. Spending hours on video games without breaks can cause _____.

   a. problem-solving skills
   b. addiction
   c. get carried away
   d. moderation

4. Taking deep breaths and listening to music is _____.

   a. encourage creativity
   b. aggression
   c. enhance hand-eye coordination
   d. a great way to unwind

5. People who shout or hit others often show _____.

   a. problem-solving skills
   b. aggression
   c. a great way to unwind
   d. social isolation

6. Eating snacks in _____ helps maintain a healthy diet.

   a. problem-solving skills
   b. aggression
   c. a great way to unwind
   d. social isolation

7. Working on challenging problems improves your _____.

   a. problem-solving skills
   b. get carried away
   c. social isolation
   d. aggression

8. Teenagers who stay home all the time may experience _____.

   a. get carried away
   b. addiction
   c. social isolation
   d. enhance hand-eye coordination

9. During competitions, players sometimes _____ with excitement.

   a. enhance hand-eye coordination
   b. addiction
   c. moderation
   d. get carried away

10. Chess and strategy games help you _____.

    a. develop quick thinking
    b. aggression
    c. problem-solving skills
    d. get carried away

**D. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.**

1. Solving puzzles under time-pressure can help **develop quick thinking**. ( )
2. Spending all day alone without talking to anyone reduces **social isolation**. ( )
3. Eating chocolate in **moderation** is an unhealthy habit. ( )
4. Painting and drawing don't **encourage creativity**. ( )
5. Hitting someone when angry shows **aggression.** ( )
6. Playing basketball can **enhance hand-eye coordination**. ( )
7. Listening to relaxing music is **a great way to unwind** after a stressful day. ( )
8. Spending 10 minutes playing video games has no risk of **addiction**. ( )
9. Working on puzzles reduces your **problem-solving skills**. ( )
10. Players sometimes **get carried away** when they're too excited about a game. ( )

# Revision

**A. <u>Directions: Read the passage and then answer the questions</u>.**

## Poppy and the Junior Tigers

Poppy observed the group of 12-year-olds listlessly dribbling basketballs around the court at the community center.

"C'mon," Poppy shouted. "More energy! Try passing." As usual, however, passing was a total disaster. Balls hit people's heads, legs, and shoulders, and only very occasionally landed in anyone's hands.

Poppy shook her head in disbelief. This was not what she had had in mind when she had volunteered to coach the community junior league basketball team.

She had figured she'd be a superb basketball coach. After all, she was a state champion forward on her high school's basketball team. Coaching would be fun! But after a few weeks with the Junior Tigers, Poppy was changing her tune. Not only were the Junior Tigers not interested in dribbling drills, but they also balked at running drills and shooting **drills**. Although Poppy had tried to explain just how important the drills were to performing well, the Junior Tigers just didn't appear to care.

Poppy called out, "Kia, you're begging for someone to steal the ball. Pass lower!

Rosa, stop fiddling with your hair and focus! Carl, don't run with the ball, but don't trip over it, either."

Mike, a tall, skinny kid who enjoyed hogging the ball, smirked. "Yeah, Carl,love your coordination." "Cut it out, Mike," said Poppy. "Can we please actually function like a team?"

That evening, Poppy explained the situation to her dad. "None of the children seem to care about playing well, and I just don't see the point when they make no effort. Maybe I should just quit and put us all out of our misery." "Or maybe they just need some really compelling motivation,"said Poppy's dad.

The following day at practice, Poppy made an announcement to the team. “You know, you guys could be playing games that make your community proud. You could be learning teamwork and cooperation skills that will help you your whole life, and some of you could maybe be good enough to one day get a basketball scholarship. Instead, you just want to fool around. You don’t care, and since you don’t care, well, I don’t care either. So, I want to tell you that today is my last day coaching you guys. Oh, and yeah, by the way, the center has to find a replacement, and unless that happens, it will be your last week for a while, as well.”




“Really?” asked Mike, looking crestfallen, his usual grin gone. “But I likebasketball.”

“Yeah, we all do. Don’t you think you’re being a little mean?” asked Kia. “We’re justkids.”

Poppy sighed, “Yep, kids that should try harder and put in real effort. Now, line up for layups. I’m still the coach for now.”

To Poppy’s surprise, the Junior Tigers actually lined up without the usual shoving and pushing. They took turns shooting at the basketin an almost orderly fashion, and when Carl missed, Mike did not make fun of him.

Poppy tried dribbling drills. While there was still a bit too much chatter and running with the ball, for once, there was no loud complaining.

At the end of practice, Poppy felt encouraged. She said, “Hey, guys! You made some effort out there, so I’ll make some effort as well. If you want to do this—really do this the right way—I’ll stick around and try to whip you into shape. What do you think? Raise your hand if you are really ready to be a team.”

Then Poppy smiled because everyone’s hand went up.

B. Directions: Reread the passage and answer the questions.

1. What is the genre of the text? Support your answer.

_____

_____

2. At the beginning of the passage, how does Poppy feel about coaching the Junior Tigers?

_____

_____

3. Why does Poppy think that she would make a great basketball coach?

_____

_____

4. What happened before Poppy had a chat with her team about their performance?
   a. She asked for her dad's advice.
   b. She consulted the community center administration office.
   c. She resigned from her job as the basketball coach.
   d. She looked for new players for the team.

5. What does Poppy need to do to get the team to practice harder, according to her dad's advice?

_____

_____

6. Use a prefix to find the antonym of the word encouraged.
   a. encouragement  b. cowardly  c. discouraged  d. depressed

7. How do the Junior Tigers change their behavior when they think Poppy is going to quit?
   a. They dispute with each other and end up quitting the team.
   b. They plead with her not to quit, but they don't improve their behavior.
   c. They complain less, treat each other better, and show more effort inpractice.
   d. They advertise in the local newspaper to find a new coach.

8. Read the following sentence from the passage:

“Although Poppy had tried to explain just how important the drills were to performing well, the Junior Tigers just didn’t appear to care.”

What is a synonym of the word “drills” according to the passage?

a. tryouts b. boreholes c. fire alarms d. misunderstandings

9. Do you think Poppy made a good choice by listening to her father’s advice? Why or why not?

_____

_____

10. What do you think the theme of this story is? Cite text evidence.

_____

_____

_____

_____



**A. Directions: Read the story and answer the questions that follow.**

**"Why the Larks Flew Away"**

A family of four young larks once lived with their mother in a nest in a wheat field. At first, the nest was very safe, for it stood on the soft ground and was hidden by the wheat.

When the wheat began to ripen, the mother lark watched carefully for any sign of the coming of the reapers. She feared that the sharp knives would cut the nest and injure the young larks.

One morning, she had to leave the nest to find some breakfast for her little ones.

"Be good children and stay in the nest," she said. "If the farmer and his son pass through the field, listen very carefully to what they say."

"Yes, Mother," cried the four baby larks.

The mother lark flew away. A few minutes later, the little larks heard the farmer and his son passing along the narrow path near the nest.

"This wheat is ripe enough to cut," said the farmer. "John, go down the road to neighbor Smith's farmhouse and ask him to come tomorrow to help us reap the grain."

When the mother lark came home, she brought some fat worms for breakfast. She found her babies chirping excitedly.

"Mother, Mother! They cried. "The men are coming to cut the wheat. We must move away tonight!"

"What did the farmer say?" asked the mother lark.

The farmer told his son to go and ask their neighbor Smith, whose house is not far from theirs, whether he would join them in cutting the grain.

"My dear children," laughed the mother lark, "as yet we have nothing to fear."

When the baby larks had eaten their breakfast, the mother lark showed them how to exercise their wings.

The next morning, before leaving, the mother lark said once more, "Stay in the nest, and if the farmer passes through the fields, be sure to listen to what he says."

"Yes, Mother," cried the little larks.

Away flew the mother, and again the farmer and his son passed through the fields.

"Did you ask neighbor Smith to help us cut the grain?" inquired the farmer.

"Yes, Father," replied the son, "and I expected him here already."

"The wheat is ripe, and it should be cut without delay," replied the farmer.

"Mount your horse and ride to your cousins' house. Ask them if they will help us."

This frightened the baby larks so much that when they saw their mother coming, they began to chirp more loudly than ever.

"What is the trouble?" called the mother as she hastened toward the nest.

"We must surely go away today!" cried the young larks. "The farmer's son has gone to bring his cousins to cut the wheat. We shall be killed if we stay here.

Again, the mother laughed. "If the farmer waits for his cousins to help him, the wheat will not be cut today."

The third morning, the mother left the nest to search for food. At noon, the farmer and his son came into the field.

"See how late it is," said the farmer, "and still not a man has come to help us. I see we must do the work ourselves. Let us go home and get everything ready. Tomorrow, before the sun is up, we shall begin to reap."

Soon after the farmer had gone, the mother lark came flying over the wheat field. The little larks told her all that they had heard.

"Now, indeed, it is time for us to be off," she said. "Shake your wings and get ready to fly. When a man makes up his mind to do his own work, it is sure to be done at once."

**B. <u>Directions: Answer the following questions</u>.**

1. What is the genre of the text? Support your answer.

_____

_____

2. Why does the mother lark want to know when the wheat fields will be reaped?

_____

_____

3. Read the sentence from the passage.
   "She feared that the sharp knives would cut the nest and injure the young larks."
   What is an antonym for the word "sharp"?
   a. pointed b. blunt c. quick d. slow

4. How would you describe the mother lark? Find text evidence to support your answer.

_____

_____

_____

5. Whom does John ask first to help cut the wheat?
   a. his neighbor
   b. his cousins
   c. his father
   d. his brother

6. Why does the mother lark tell her baby larks, "If the farmer and his son pass through the field, listen very carefully to what they say"?
   a. She wants to know when the farmer will be reaping the fields.
   b. She doesn't want the baby larks to get bored.
   c. She wants the baby larks to improve their hearing.
   d. She likes to know secrets.

7. Why doesn't the mother lark care about moving her family when John asks his cousins and neighbor Smith to reap the fields?

_____

_____

_____

8. What does the farmer finally decide to do about his fields?
   a. He asks neighbor Smith to help him reap the fields.
   b. He decides to talk to the larks to warn them.
   c. He decides not to reap the fields that season.
   d. He decides that he and his son will reap the fields themselves.

9. How would the story end differently if the farmer decided to keep waiting for help from others?

_____

_____

_____

10. What is the theme of this story? Explain.

_____

_____

_____

# Vocabulary Revision

**Prompt 1**

**A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the words and expressions below.**

| **boost – give it her all – push oneself too hard – physical exhaustion – plays a vital role** |
|---|

1. Reading books every day can _____ your imagination.
2. She tried to _____ in the competition, even though she was tired.
3. If athletes _____, they risk serious injuries.
4. After the long match, the players suffered from _____.
5. Good nutrition _____ in maintaining a strong immune system.

**B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the words and expressions below.**

| **reduce – time-consuming – opponents – expense** |
|---|

1. Training for the tournament was very _____ and left little time for studying.
2. Using renewable energy can _____ greenhouse gas emissions.
3. Buying professional sports equipment can be a heavy _____ for families.
4. Some _____ opposed the plan to build a new highway.

**C. Directions: Choose the correct answer.**

1. Team meetings and collaboration _____ in solving big problems.
   a. claim b. reduce c. play a vital role d. opponents
2. Taking short breaks can help _____ focus and energy at work.
   a. boost b. give it her all c. reduce d. expense
3. Some politicians were _____ of raising taxes for education.
   a. opponents c. increase productivity
   b. time-consuming d. expense
4. _____ of the new sports program believe it will improve students' health.
   a. reduce b. Proponents c. play a vital role d. give it her all

5. After the long hike, the group suffered from _____.
   a. reduce  b. physical exhaustion  c. expense  d. opponents
6. She decided to _____ during her presentation to impress the audience.
   a. give it her all  b. play a vital role  c. reduce  d. boost
7. Athletes who _____ risk serious injuries.
   a. push themselves too hard  c. opponents
   b. play a vital role  d. reduce
8. Traveling abroad for the tournament was a major _____ for the team.
   a. reduce  b. give it her all  c. opponents  d. expense
9. Careful planning shows that the _____ of improving public transport outweigh the drawbacks.
   a. benefits  b. opponents  c. play a vital role  d. boost
10. Preparing for final exams can be very _____.
    a. reduce  b. time-consuming  c. expense  d. boost

**D. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.**

1. Eating vegetables can **boost** your health. (  )
2. **Proponents** of renewable energy believe that it helps protect the environment. (  )
3. Planting trees can **reduce** air pollution. (  )
4. Writing a detailed explanation can be **time-consuming**. (  )
5. The school trip was a fun experience, but it came with a high **expense**. (  )
6. The sun **plays a vital role** in giving us heat and light. (  )
7. You can **give it your all** by putting in effort and focus. (  )
8. Some people are **opponents** of unfair rules. (  )
9. After helping move all the furniture, she felt **physical exhaustion** and needed to rest. (  )
10. Sometimes the **benefits outweigh the drawbacks** when taking calculated risks. (  )

**Prompt 2**

**A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| **show appreciation – create memories – pressure to impress – a pain in the neck – feel valued** |
|---|

1. Receiving praise for her work made her _____.
2. Sending a thank-you card is a way to _____.
3. Cleaning the attic was really _____.
4. Family vacations are a great way to _____.
5. Athletes often feel _____ their coaches during tryouts.

**B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| **count your blessings – owe her a debt of gratitude – cost an arm and a leg – exclusion – strengthen bonds** |
|---|

1. I truly _____ for all her support.
2. Playing board games together can _____ among friends.
3. The designer handbag _____, but she saved for months.
4. Experiencing _____ in group activities can make students shy away from participating in the future.
5. She learned to _____ every day and be grateful.

**C. Directions: Choose the correct answer.**

1. Saying “thank you” to someone shows that you **_____.**

a. create memories
b. show appreciation
c. gratitude
d. count your blessings

2. Going on trips with family helps to **_____.**

a. spread joy and positivity
b. strengthen bonds
c. cost an arm and a leg
d. feel valued

3. The child's _____ from the birthday party made him cry.

a. create memories
b. exclusion
c. a pain in the neck
d. feel valued

4. A broken washing machine can be really _____.

a. a pain in the neck
b. gratitude
c. strengthen bonds
d. owe someone a debt of gratitude

5. She _____ after winning the award.

a. cost an arm and a leg
b. felt valued
c. count your blessings
d. spread joy and positivity

6. We can _____ by keeping a daily journal.

a. create memories
b. owe someone a debt of gratitude
c. strengthen bonds
d. cost an arm and a leg

7. She saved money for a long time because the new phone _____.

a. felt valued
b. cost an arm and a leg
c. show appreciation
d. spread joy and positivity

8. _____ and be thankful for the small and big things in your life.

a. count your blessings
b. create memories
c. a pain in the neck
d. strengthen bonds

9. You _____ when you are thankful for their help.

a. count your blessings
b. owe someone a debt of gratitude
c. spread joy and positivity
d. felt valued

10. He felt _____ during the job interview, so he practiced carefully.

a. strengthen bonds
b. a pain in the neck
c. cost an arm and a leg
d. pressure to impress

**C. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.**

1. She wore her nicest outfit because she felt **pressure to impress** her classmates. ( )

2. Playing board games together can **strengthen bonds** among friends. ( )

3. Ignoring kind actions does **not** help to **show appreciation**. ( )
4. Giving gifts to friends always **costs an arm and a leg**. ( )
5. Social media may cause feelings of **exclusion** when friends post pictures of events you weren't invited to. ( )
6. Cleaning a messy garage can't be **a pain in the neck**. ( )
7. Receiving praise can make someone **feel valued**. ( )
8. Forgetting to be thankful shows that you **count your blessings**. ( )
9. You **owe someone a debt of gratitude** when they help you. ( )
10. Taking photos on a trip helps to **create memories**. ( )

**Prompt 3**

**A. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| ***addiction – enhance hand-eye coordination – got carried away – problem-solving skills – social isolation*** |
|---|

1. Playing video games for too long can lead to _____.
2. Playing handball regularly can _____.
3. Sometimes people _____ while playing games.
4. Working on puzzles can improve your _____.
5. Spending too much time alone can cause _____.

**B. Directions: Fill in the blanks using the given words and expressions.**

| **encourage creativity – develop quick thinking – moderation – a great way to unwind – aggression** |
|---|

1. Playing team sports helps children _____.
2. Drinking water in _____ is good for your health.
3. Creating crafts help to _____.
4. Yelling or hitting when frustrated is a sign of _____.
5. Reading a book in a quiet room is _____.

**C. <u>Directions: Choose the correct answer</u>.**

1. Spending hours on video games without breaks can cause _____.

   a. moderation
   b. addiction
   c. encourage creativity
   d. a great way to unwind

2. Practicing basketball helps to _____.

   a. enhance hand-eye coordination
   b. moderation
   c. aggression
   d. addiction

3. Completing logic puzzles can help you _____.

   a. develop quick thinking
   b. aggression
   c. moderation
   d. a great way to unwind

4. Painting, drawing, and crafts are activities that _____.

   a. encourage creativity
   b. got carried away
   c. addiction
   d. social isolation

5. Shouting at classmates shows _____.

   a. problem-solving skills
   b. aggression
   c. a great way to unwind
   d. moderation

6. _____ can happen when spending too much time alone.

   a. social isolation
   b. enhance hand-eye coordination
   c. got carried away
   d. problem-solving skills

7. Watching a calm movie after a long day is _____.

   a. got carried away
   b. a great way to unwind
   c. aggression
   d. addiction

8. Eating unhealthy snacks without limits shows lack of _____.

   a. moderation
   b. enhance hand-eye coordination
   c. encourage creativity
   d. problem-solving skills

9. Getting too excited and spending all your allowance is an example of _____.

   a. got carried away
   b. social isolation
   c. develop quick thinking
   d. a great way to unwind

10. Playing strategy games can improve _____.

    a. problem-solving skills
    b. aggression
    c. addiction
    d. a pain in the neck

**D. <u>Directions: Write (T) for true sentences and (F) for the false ones</u>.**

1. Spending too much time playing games can lead to **addiction**. (  )
2. Team sports help to **develop quick thinking**. (  )
3. Painting or drawing does **not** help to **encourage creativity**. (  )
4. Yelling at people is an example of **aggression**. (  )
5. Spending too much time alone may cause **social isolation**. (  )
6. Drinking water in **moderation** is healthy. (  )
7. Watching a movie after work is **a great way to unwind**. (  )
8. Practicing **hand-eye coordination** drills does **not** help in sports. (  )
9. People sometimes **get carried away** while celebrating. (  )
10. Working on puzzles improves your **problem-solving skills**. (  )

# Model Exam Paper II

## I. Reading Comprehension ( /10)

**A) <u>Directions: Read the passage. Use the reread strategy to check for understanding as you read.</u>**

### On the Porch

Hattie settled in her chair on the porch of her ranch house, waiting for the sun to rise above Tule Mountain. On her lap was a pillow, ready to be embroidered, and she only needed the warm glow of the sun to provide light for her work. As the purple clouds spread across the sky, Hattie breathed a sigh of satisfaction. She could think of no other place where she could have fulfilled her dreams as she had on this ranch.



Everyone for miles around knew Hattie as one of the original inhabitants of the Big Bend region of western Texas, but she had not always been a Texan. Growing up in the city of St. Louis, Missouri, Hattie had always known she was made for adventure. After graduating from high school, she followed her dream and became a teacher in a border town along the Rio Grande. At the end of the Civil War, only 18 years old, she left the comforts of home to relocate to a distant area.

After working for a year in her small schoolhouse, she met Edward. She and Edward married and moved onto his ranch. She still remembered their first home fondly. It was a one-room shack equipped with a wood stove, a table, two chairs, and one cabinet to hold their few possessions. They slept on quilts piled on the floor in the corner.

Together, Hattie and Edward built up the ranch and started a family. Their marriage had been a true partnership. Alongside Edward, Hattie baled the hay, mended broken fences, and herded the cattle to market. “Many hands make light work,” she liked to tell her husband as they worked side by side.

They increased the size of their home to make room for their children, and then one night their house burned down in a grass fire. As Edward kicked angrily in the rubble, Hattie patted his hand. “It’s no use crying over spilled milk,” she said. Instead of feeling sorry for her family, she planned a bigger house and helped to build it.

Hattie and Edward’s life had not been only work. Edward played a lively fiddle, and in the evenings the whole family sang their favorite songs. Hattie spent some of her precious free time going over numbers and letters

with her children and teaching them to read, but some of her most treasured memories were the quiet times when she and Edward watched the sunrise together from this very spot on the porch.

Memories of their life together greeted Hattie ever since Edward's death many years ago. He certainly would have been proud of the way that she managed without him. She always found a way for the family and ranch to thrive, despite hard times, and there had been plenty of those.

She ran the ranch single-handedly when her two oldest sons joined the army to fight in World War I. She nursed the youngest children back to health when they fell ill with Spanish influenza. Then there was the drought that kept the rain from falling for months at a time. The cattle grew weak and sick. A trusted ranch hand tried to take advantage of her worries by tricking her into selling the ranch. But she caught on to him, fired him, and kicked him out. Like other strong women of her generation, she had gritted her teeth and gotten on with life.



"I will always belong to this ranch," she said as she admired the beauty of the land in the morning sunshine. "I rode the fence lines, I worked the cattle, and I hired every ranch employee. Yes, I have seen many sights in my ninety years. But this will always be the finest sight of all." Hattie picked up her needle and thread. She would place this new pillow on her sofa, embroidered with the phrase, "Home is where the heart is."

**B) <u>Directions: Answer the following questions.</u>**

1. **What is the genre of the passage?**

a. fantasy
b. historical fiction
c. folktale
d. autobiography

2. **What was Hattie waiting for before she started her embroidery? (Refer to the first paragraph)**

_____

_____

3. **What did Hattie do after she graduated from high school? (Refer to the second paragraph).**

_____

_____

4. **What do Hattie's actions during the grass fire and after tell you about her personality? (Refer to lines 25 to 30)**

_____

_____

5. **What does the phrase “It’s no use crying over spilled milk” mean in the way Hattie used it?**

i. She wanted more milk.
ii. Don’t be sad about something you can’t change.
iii. Be careful next time.
iv. Milk is hard to clean up.

6. **What does the phrase “gritted her teeth” tell us about Hattie?**

"Like other strong women of her generation, she had **gritted her teeth** and gotten on with life."

a. She smiled happily.
b. She was angry.
c. She showed strength and didn’t give up.
d. She had sore teeth.

7. **What did Hattie like to do with her children in her free time? (Refer to lines 30 to 35)**

_____

_____

8. “Memories of their life together greeted Hattie ever since Edward’s death…”
**What kind of figurative language is used in this sentence?**

a. smile
b. metaphor
c. personification
d. hyperbole

**9. What effect did the drought have on the ranch and Hattie's cattle? (Refer to lines 40 to 50)**

_____

_____

**10. Why do you think Hattie chose to sew the words "Home is where the heart is" on the pillow?**

_____

_____

_____

_____

## II. Vocabulary ( /10)

**A. Directions: Fill in the gaps using the words below.**

**cost an arm and a leg – addiction – strengthen bonds – show appreciation – time-consuming– a great way to unwind**

1. Playing too much video games can lead to _____ if a person cannot stop.
2. Taking breaks is _____ after a stressful day.
3. Managers should _____ when employees try their best.
4. Doing homework can be _____ when there is a lot to finish.
5. Team sports help _____ between players.
6. Buying a new phone can _____ a lot of money.

**B. Directions: Choose the correct answer.**

1. After hours of studying for the final exam, Sara felt great _____ and had to rest.
   a. boost
   b. physical exhaustion
   c. opponents
   d. encouragement

2. James loves painting because it helps him relax; it's really _____ after a long day at school.
   a. a great way to unwind
   b. pressure to impress
   c. a pain in the neck
   d. get carried away

3. It's important to eat in _____; too much junk food can be harmful.
   a. moderation
   b. opponents
   c. social isolation
   d. quick thinking

4. When working on the group project, Mia showed excellent _____ by solving every problem the team faced.
   a. problem-solving skills
   b. physical exhaustion
   c. expense
   d. exclusion

5. Sometimes people feel lonely because of _____, which makes them miss social interactions.
   a. social isolation
   b. opponents
   c. benefits outweigh drawbacks
   d. get carried away

6. The new smartphone _____, so I had to save money for months to buy it.
   a. play a vital role
   b. costs an arm and a leg
   c. feel valued
   d. encouragement

7. Too many chores and after-school activities can be _____, leaving students with little time to relax.
   a. time-consuming
   b. a great way to unwind
   c. boost
   d. owe a debt of gratitude

8. When Lara completed the big group project, her teacher told her she should be proud and recognized for her work. This made her _____.
   a. feel valued
   b. aggression
   c. opponents
   d. a pain in the neck

**C. <u>Directions: Write T for true sentences or F for the false ones.</u>**

1. Moderation means doing something in a balanced way. **(  )**
2. Aggression means being kind to others. **(  )**
3. Social isolation means spending time with friends. **(  )**
4. When something is helpful, it's a pain in the neck. **(  )**
5. To count your blessings is to be thankful. **(  )**
6. Opponents are people who support an idea. **(  )**

## III. Writing (  /10)

**Directions: Write an argumentative essay discussing the advantages and disadvantages of extended recess time at schools.**

| **Million-Dollar Words List** | |
|---|---|
| **Introduction** | |
| ① General Statement | Thesis Statement |

**Body Paragraph 1: Pros**

| ② Topic Sentence: | |
|---|---|
| Reason | Elaboration |
| Example | Closing sentence |

**Body Paragraph 2: Cons**

| ③ Topic Sentence: | |
|---|---|
| Reason | Elaboration |
| Example | Closing sentence |

**Closing**

| ④ Restate Thesis |
|---|
| Call for action |

| Ideas<br>1 | Organization<br>2 | Voice<br>1 | Sentence Fluency<br>1 | Creativity/ Word Choice<br>2 | Conventions<br>2 | Handwriting<br>1 | Total<br>10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | |